

# ServiceNow Development with Flow Designer

## Project Documentation

### 1. Introduction

- **Project Title:** Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
- **Date:** 30 September 2026
- **Team Members:**
  - o Sribaskar S – Team Lead (Milestone 1: Flow)
  - o Bharath E – Member (Milestone 2: Flow Assignment)
  - o Sanjay D – Member (Milestone 2: Flow Assignment)
  - o Santhanamarimuthu K – Member (Milestone 3: Service Catalog)
  - o Gowtham M – Member (Conclusion and documentation)

### 2. Project Overview

- **Purpose:** To automate the standard laptop ordering process in ServiceNow using Flow Designer so that, once a request is approved, a catalog task is generated automatically and assigned to the Hardware group for configuration. This reduces manual effort, errors and user waiting time.
- **Features:**
  - o Standard Laptop catalog item available under Service Catalog > Hardware, ordered with Order Now
  - o Approval step on the request through the Approvers section
  - o Flow "Standard laptop task" with a Service Catalog trigger
  - o Create Catalog Task action with short description "Laptop need to Configured",

Assignment group "Hardware" and Approval "Approved"

- o Flow attached to the Standard Laptop catalog item through the Process Engine
- o Catalog task visible in the Requested Item record for tracking

### 3. Architecture

- **Frontend:** ServiceNow Service Catalog and platform UI. The requester browses Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop and places the order; approvers and the hardware team work from the Request, Requested Item and Catalog Task forms.
- **Backend:** ServiceNow Flow Designer (Process Automation). The flow "Standard laptop task" runs as the System User in the Global application. A Service Catalog trigger starts the flow, and the Create Catalog Task action generates the task from the Requested Item record.
- **Database:** ServiceNow platform tables – Request (sc\_request), Requested Item (sc\_req\_item), Catalog Task (sc\_task), Catalog Item (sc\_cat\_item) and Group (sys\_user\_group). The flow reads the Requested Item and writes a new Catalog Task record with the Hardware assignment group.

### 4. Setup Instructions

- **Prerequisites:**

- o A ServiceNow instance (for example a Personal Developer Instance) and a user with admin access
- o Standard Laptop catalog item available in Service Catalog > Hardware
- o Hardware assignment group available in the instance
- o A web browser to access the instance

- **Installation / Configuration:**

- o Open ServiceNow > All > Flow Designer (Process Automation) > New > Flow
- o Name the flow "Standard laptop task", set Application to Global and Run as to System User, then Submit

- o Add the Service Catalog trigger, then add the action Create Catalog Task with the Requested Item record dragged into Request item
- o Set Short description "Laptop need to Configured"; add field values for Description, Assignment group (Hardware) and Approval (Approved)
- o Save and Activate the flow
- o Open All > Maintain Items > Standard Laptop > Process engine, remove other automations, add the flow "Standard laptop task" and save

## 5. Folder Structure

- **Client:** No custom client code. The user-facing part is the Service Catalog (Hardware category > Standard Laptop catalog item) delivered by the ServiceNow platform.
- **Server:** The configuration is organised as Flow Designer flow "Standard laptop task" (trigger + Create Catalog Task action), the Standard Laptop catalog item (Process Engine > Flow), and the platform tables sc\_request, sc\_req\_item and sc\_task.

## 6. Running the Application

- The solution runs inside the ServiceNow instance; no local servers are required.
- **Order:** All > Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop > Order Now.
- **Approve:** Open the request number from the order status page > Approvers section > right-click the record > Approve.
- **Verify:** Open the Requested Item > Catalog Tasks section > open the task to check the short description and the Hardware assignment group.

## 7. API Documentation

- The project is configured with Flow Designer and does not expose any custom REST endpoints.
- The standard ServiceNow Table API can be used if the data needs to be read externally, for example GET /api/now/table/sc\_task to list catalog tasks and GET /api/now/table/sc\_req\_item to list requested items.

## **8. Authentication**

- Users sign in to the ServiceNow instance with their own credentials; access is controlled by roles and access controls (ACLs).
- The flow runs as the System User so that the catalog task can be created regardless of the requester's roles.
- Approval is handled through the Approvers section of the request, so the request is processed only after an approver approves it.

## **9. User Interface**

- Service Catalog page – Hardware category with the Standard Laptop item and the Order Now button.
- Order status page – shows the request number that links to the Request record.
- Request, Requested Item and Catalog Task forms – used for approval and for tracking the configuration task. Screenshots of each step are included in the project document.

## **10. Testing**

- Manual end-to-end testing in the ServiceNow instance:
  - o Place an order for the Standard Laptop and confirm a request number is generated
  - o Approve the request from the Approvers section and confirm the state changes to Approved
  - o Open the Requested Item > Catalog Tasks and confirm the task exists with short description "Laptop need to Configured" and Assignment group "Hardware"
  - o Check the flow execution in Flow Designer > Executions to confirm it completed without errors

## **11. Screenshots or Demo**

- Step-by-step screenshots for Milestone 1 (Flow), Milestone 2 (Flow assignment) and Milestone 3 (Service Catalog) are available in the project document "Streamlining IT

Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer".

## **12. Known Issues**

- The flow is attached only to the Standard Laptop catalog item; other catalog items are not covered.
- The assignment group is fixed to Hardware and the short description is a fixed value inside the flow.
- Notifications to the requester about task progress are not configured.

## **13. Future Enhancements**

- Add email or portal notifications for the requester when the laptop is configured and ready.
- Extend the flow to other catalog items such as high-end laptops, monitors and accessories.
- Use catalog variables to create different tasks for different laptop configurations.
- Add dashboards to report on request volume, approval time and configuration time.